

Lymphoid Tissue Histopathology - UPDATED Factoids

Released Schoenlein 14-slide review deck integrated • normal histology only

Deck sequence: diffuse lymphatic tissue -> primary nodule -> secondary nodule -> Peyer's patch -> lymph node -> thymus -> tonsil -> spleen.

Diffuse tissue + nodules

Structure	Released-slide recognition	Key phrase
Diffuse lymphatic tissue	Scattered lymphocytes with dark nuclei and scant cytoplasm	Can be solitary or part of tonsil/Peyer's
Primary nodule	More organized lymphocytes supported by reticular connective tissue	Reticular fibers = Type III collagen network
Secondary nodule	Like primary but with a pale germinal center	Germinal center contains maturing lymphocytes
Peyer's patch	Lymphoid tissue in the mucosa of the ileum	Nodules + diffuse lymphoid tissue

Primary vs secondary nodule: if you see a pale germinal center, call it secondary.

Lymph node - Slides 6-8

Region	Released-slide cue	Cell/flow anchor
Capsule	Dense CT over the node	Outer boundary
Subcapsular sinus	Space directly under capsule	Afferent drainage enters
Outer cortex	Many lymphoid nodules	B cells
Deep cortex / paracortex	More diffuse tissue	T cells
Medullary cords	Dark-staining projections	B-cell-rich cords per slide
Medullary sinuses	Light-staining channels	Lymph flows here
Hilum	Indentation	Efferent drainage exits

B/T map

Outer cortex = B-cell nodules.

Deep cortex/paracortex = T-cell diffuse tissue.

Flow map

Afferent -> subcapsular sinus -> node compartments -> medullary sinuses -> efferent at hilum.

Thymus, Tonsil & Spleen

Thymus - Slides 9-10

Feature	Released-slide wording
Lobules	Distinct lobules with 2 layers
Cortex	Darker staining; contains immature T cells
Medulla	Lighter staining; contains more mature T cells
Epithelial reticular cells	Large flat stromal cells around lymphoid cells
Hassall's corpuscles	Large keratinized structures in medulla surrounded by ERCs

Tonsil - Slide 11

Many distinct lymphoid nodules + deep tonsillar crypts of invaginated epithelial tissue.

Spleen - Slides 12-14

Feature	Released-slide recognition
Capsule	Thick capsule
Trabeculae	Extend into organ; contain trabecular arteries
Red pulp	Less dense/lighter; splenic sinuses + surrounding cords
White pulp	More dense/darker; diffuse + nodular lymphoid tissue
Central arteriole	Branch of trabecular arteriole
PALS	Periarterial lymphatic sheath surrounding central arteriole; diffuse lymphatic tissue

One-look organ discrimination

If you see...	Think...
Pale germinal center inside a lymphoid nodule	Secondary nodule
Ileal mucosa packed with lymphoid nodules	Peyer's patch
Capsule + subcapsular sinus + B cortex + T paracortex + medulla	Lymph node
Lobules + dark cortex + pale medulla + Hassall corpuscles	Thymus
Deep epithelial crypts + many nodules	Tonsil
Red/white pulp + central arteriole/PALS	Spleen

Official-objective gap: the released review deck contains **no pathologic lymphadenopathy specimens**. Do not memorize the old pre-SAL reactive-pattern list as though it came from these slides.

Last 30 seconds: primary = no pale GC • secondary = pale GC • node outer cortex B / paracortex T • thymus dark cortex/light medulla/Hassall • tonsil crypts • Peyer's ileum • spleen red-white pulp + central arteriole/PALS.

Primary source: released Schoenlein Lymphoid Histology review deck. No dedicated lymphoid-tissue Word companion exists.